

HOROLOGICAL MASTER COLLECTION SERIES

PART II

A TRIO OF SWISS ARTISANS

The Idea, the Engine and the Cathedral

Breguet × Jaeger-LeCoultre × Vacheron Constantin

MASTER COLLECTION GUIDE | 2026 EDITION | v2.0 | AUGUST 2026

16 COLLECTOR CARDS | 4 OWNED FOUNDATIONS + THE CANON | MARKET BANDS VALIDATED AUGUST 2026

Paris invented it. The valley built it. Geneva composed it. One collection, three voices.

The thesis

Modern fine watchmaking is a conversation between three places, and this collection owns the conversation. A watch earns a chapter only if it is **(a) a documented crossing between the houses**, or **(b) the definitive statement of a virtue one house owns outright**. Beautiful is not sufficient. Prestigious is not sufficient. If the card cannot say what the watch *teaches*, the watch is padding.

PARIS — THE IDEA

Abraham-Louis Breguet, born Neuchâtel 1747, set up at the Quai de l'Horloge in 1775 and proceeded to invent a startling share of everything: the overcoil balance spring (1795) that beats inside a century of fine calibres including JLC's and VC's; the pare-chute anti-shock (c.1790); the self-winding perpétuelle; the souscription watch (1796); the tourbillon (patented 1801); and the visual grammar — coined hands, secret signature, guilloché, those numerals — that every dress watch on earth still speaks.

THE VALLÉE DE JOUX — THE ENGINE

LeCoultre, from 1833, turned ideas into industrialized precision: the millionomètre, the great ébauches, calibre 920. The valley engineered what Paris imagined.

GENEVA — THE CATHEDRAL

Vacheron Constantin, from 1755 the oldest watchmaker alive, composed engineering into objects with Geneva Seal solemnity. VC's cal 1003 is JLC's 803 in Geneva dress; VC's cal 1120 is JLC's 920 — the engine that powered the Royal Oak, the Nautilus and the 222, and that JLC never once signed.

AND THE PUNCHLINE THAT CLOSES THE LOOP

In the 1990s, Breguet acquired Leman of L'Orient — and the house of ideas physically moved *into the Engine's valley*, where it builds today. Idea, Engine, Cathedral: three roles, one geography by the end, one collection.

THE HIDDEN TRIANGLE — THE CHRONOMETRY COVENANT, RENEWED ROUGHLY ONCE A CENTURY, ONCE PER HOUSE



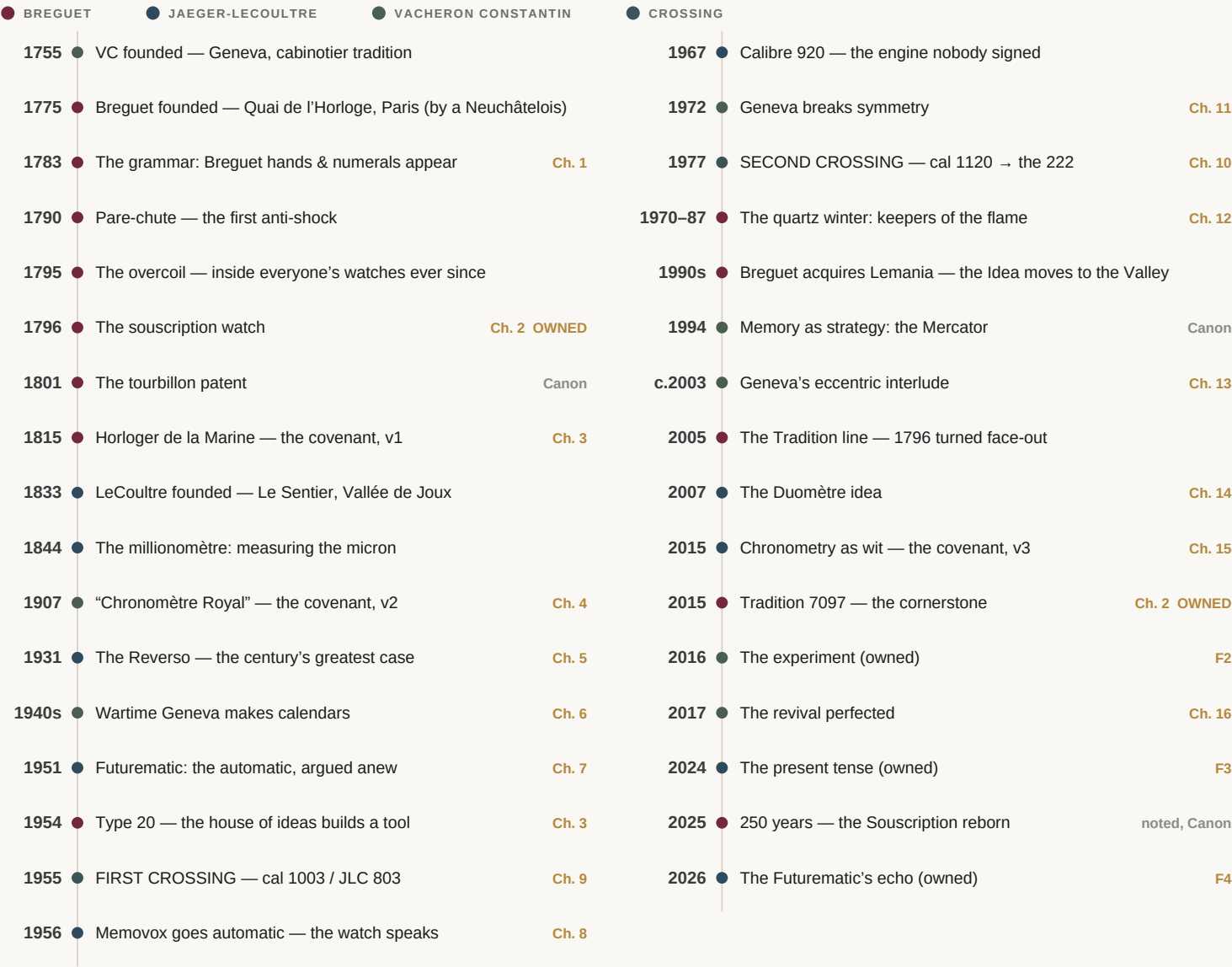
Three houses making the same promise: telling the truth about time. *Tell this one at dinner.*

THE COLLECTION NOW OPENS AND CLOSES ON ITSELF

The collection opens with the Idea (your Tradition 7097, Ch. 2) and closes with the Echo (the 2026 Master Control quoting the 1951 Futurematic, F4). First and last pages are already in the case or on order — the middle is the hunt. Sixteen chapters, four owned foundations and a small Canon.

THE TIMELINE SPINE

The full 1755–2026 arc, with chapter markers. Three houses, one argument: the Idea (Breguet, Paris), the Engine (Jaeger-LeCoultre, the Vallée de Joux) and the Cathedral (Vacheron Constantin, Geneva) — with two documented crossings where the same movement carries two names.



THE HUNT LIST

Acquisition order as the draft states it. Bands are working acquisition ranges validated against sold transactions (2026-08-13/14), not dealer askings — with two flagged exceptions carried in print. **Malte Dual Time Regulator** stays opportunistic on the live negotiation; the **VC 4240** is a standing condition-first hunt throughout.

1.	JLC Futurematic E501 Ch. 7 Best story-per-dollar in the collection. Buy first.	VALUE \$4,000–6,500
2.	JLC Memovox Automatic Calendar E855 Ch. 8 The alarm chapter, at trade money. Buy second.	VALUE \$3,000–4,250
3.	JLC Geophysic True Second Ch. 15 Buy third — and buy it on the global channel, not the US shelf.	VALUE \$5,500–7,000
→ The Breguet evidence pass sits here Done 2026-08-14; bands folded in. Residual gaps: 7147 ask-derived, Roth-era low-confidence.		
4.	Breguet Type XX Aéronavale 3800 Ch. 3 Offers out at \$4,250 — dead mid-band. The cheapest real chapter in the trio.	VALUE \$3,800–5,200
5.	VC Historiques Triple Calendrier 1942 (3110V) Ch. 16 The safest serious purchase in the guide; best evidence on the list.	CORE \$16,500–19,000
6.	Breguet Classique (5157 path / 7147) Ch. 1 The 7147 band is ASK-DERIVED, low conf — negotiate hard or choose the 5157.	VALUE-to-CORE \$8,000–13,000 / \$13,000–18,000
7.	VC Les Historiques Ultra-Fine 1955 Ch. 9 The thesis made physical — one movement, two names.	SPLURGE \$11,000–15,000
8.	VC Historiques Chronomètre Royal 1907 Ch. 4 Price the service in; the one verified sale was service-due.	CORE \$15,500–19,000
9.	JLC Reverso Tribute Monoface Small Seconds Ch. 5 Low conf — 0 solds priced; validate before buying.	CORE \$7,800–10,500
10.	VC Overseas gen-1 (42042) Ch. 10 The buyable descendant of the 920/1120 story; the bracelet is the design.	CORE \$6,500–12,500
11.	VC “1972” asymmetric (37010 echo) Ch. 11 Or hunt the 1970s 35202-family original — band TBV per example.	CORE \$8,500–12,000
12.	Chaumet-era / Daniel Roth Breguet Ch. 12 LOW confidence — fresh comps MANDATORY before any purchase.	CORE-to-SPLURGE \$14,000–22,000
13.	JLC Duomètre à Chronographe Ch. 14 The modern engine argument; the old \$18k floor is now the center.	SPLURGE \$17,000–21,500

THE BUDGET ARCHITECTURE — THE LOGISTICS LAYER, STATED ONCE

VALUE	Futurematic · Memovox · Geophysic · Type XX 3800	~\$20,000 for four irreplaceable chapters
CORE	CR 1907 · Reverso Tribute · 4240 · 42042 · “1972” · 3110V · Classique 5157 · (Malte DTR if the deal lands)	~\$85–110k across years
SPLURGE	Ultra-Fine 1955 · Duomètre · Roth-era Breguet †	~\$45–58k — where the object IS the argument
CANON	Tourbillon · Souscription 2025 · Mercator · 222	\$0 standing

Validated spend (JLC/VC chapters, review bands): ~\$125,000–140,000 depending on alternates. **Breguet additions (validated 2026-08-14):** ~\$26,000–40,000 across Chs. 1, 3 and 12. **Trio core plan:** ~\$155,000–175,000 — every band in the plan now sold-validated, with two flagged exceptions (7147 ask-derived; Roth-era low-confidence, fresh comps mandatory). † Roth-era band is LOW confidence (two public solds, 2006/2011) — fresh comps mandatory before that purchase.

BREGUET · CH. 01 · 1783

TARGET

Classique 7147 / 5157

The grammar of watchmaking

Breguet Classique — refs verified Aug 2026



Photo: Montres Breguet (breguet.com product pages)

WHAT IT TEACHES

Open any dress-watch catalog from any brand and you are reading Breguet's handwriting: the hollow-moon "Breguet hands," the cursive numerals, hand-turned guilloché, the secret signature etched against counterfeiters — all of it from one Paris bench in the 1780s. A modern Classique is the living textbook of that grammar, still made with rose-engine guilloché in the Vallée. This chapter is why your friends' dress watches look the way they do, whoever made them.

REFERENCES 7147 silvered guilloché — 7147BB/12/9WU white gold · 7147BR/12/9WU rose gold (/29/ = grand feu enamel)

ALTERNATE PATH Ultra-thin 5157 — 5157BR/11/9V6 · 5157BB/11/9V6

CURATORIAL Choice of ref is the curatorial call

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

TIER

Validated 2026-08-14: \$8,000–13,000 for the ultra-thin 5157 path · med conf (3 solds, all >18mo) · the 7147 runs \$13,000–18,000 ASK-DERIVED, low conf (zero public solds found) — negotiate hard or choose the 5157 · used, full set preferred, dealer/auction

VALUE-to-CORE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Silvered guilloché dial, the smaller classic sizes wear best; used Classiques are quietly one of haute horlogerie's great value plays — nobody hypes them, everybody who handles one keeps it.

How to read a card

Every card leads with what the watch *teaches*. Specification, market band and buying wisdom follow — price is an overlay in this collection, never the headline. The rule that admits a watch: it is either a documented crossing between the houses, or the definitive statement of a virtue one house owns outright.

CARD BANNERS

TARGET

In the plan; hunt when the right example surfaces.

THE CORNERSTONE · OWNED

Already in the case; the chapter is told.

OWNED / FOUNDATION

Owned or on order; carried in Part B.

STRETCH

Where the object IS the argument.

IN NEGOTIATION

Live discussion; the walk-away number is printed on the card.

OFFERS OUT

Non-binding offers already submitted.

CANON

Acknowledged, unranked, no capital assigned.

ALTERNATE

A second legitimate teller for a chapter already open.

READING THE BAND BLOCK

Med conf — several sold comparables inside the review window. **Low conf** — one or no realized sale; validate before buying. **ASK-DERIVED** — no public solds found: the number is built from asking prices and must be negotiated against. **TBV** — to be validated; no band is offered and none should be inferred.

TIERS

VALUE · CORE · SPLURGE · CANON — the budget architecture on the hunt-list page. Owned pieces carry no tier: the capital is already spent and the chapter already told.

BREGUET · CH. 02 · 1796 → 2015

THE CORNERSTONE · OWNED

Tradition 7097 “Automatique Seconde Rétrograde”

The idea, made visible

Cal. 505SR · 40 mm · OWNED — the collection's most beloved piece, and now its opening chapter



Photo: Montres Breguet (breguet.com) — white gold 7097BB; a Marc original leads at print

WHAT IT TEACHES

In 1796 Breguet designed the souscription watch — one hand, one barrel dead-center, symmetric bridges, sold by subscription to democratize genius. In 2005 the Tradition line turned that 200-year-old architecture *face-out*: what was hidden becomes the dial. Your 7097 shows the pare-chute doing its work at 10 o'clock, the retrograde seconds arcing where a souscription's hand once swept, the whole movement performing its own history in real time. It is the single clearest possible statement of this collection's thesis — **the Idea, made visible** — and it was the cornerstone before the guide knew to look for it.

CALIBRE

505SR — officially 505SR1

SIZE

40 mm

REFS FOR THE RECORD

7097BB/G1/9WU white gold · 7097BR/G1/9WU rose gold

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

OWNED · no band needed · the seriousness, already in the case

TIER

OWNED

FACT-CHECK, AUG 2026

The calibre — officially 505SR1 — is NOT a borrowed ultra-thin; it is a Tradition-family movement built on the souscription pocket-watch architecture (507DR lineage) with a hammer rotor quoting Breguet's perpétuelle. The movement isn't just displaying the 1796 idea — it IS the 1796 idea, re-engineered.

CURATORIAL NOTE

This watch anchoring the collection re-ranks everything: the guide is no longer “JLC × VC with a guest” — it is a three-voice fugue and this is the subject stated first.

BREGUET · CH. 03 · 1815 → 1954

OFFERS OUT

Type XX Aéronavale

In the service of the state

Neo-vintage ref 3800 (3800ST/92/9W6, steel/black — the value path) or a 1950s–60s Type 20 (the romance path)



Photo: European Watch Company — steel bracelet variant 3800ST/92/SW9 (see index)

WHAT IT TEACHES

The house of ideas was also a house of *duty*. In 1815 Breguet became Horloger de la Marine Royale — precision as a naval instrument, the covenant’s first signing. From 1954 the same house was delivering Type 20 flyback chronographs to the French military — the Air Force first (1955–59), the Aéronavale by 1960: the inventor’s firm building military tools, guilloché nowhere in sight. This chapter keeps the collection honest — genius that reports for work. It also gives the Breguet voice its sport slot, beside the Polaris and the Overseas.

CALIBRE

Cal. 582 (Lemania-based)

ALTERNATE TELLER

A Marine (neo-vintage 3400-family, or the current 5517) tells the 1815 half without the aviation romance — one slot, your choice of century.

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

Validated 2026-08-14: \$3,800–5,200 (ref 3800, no box/papers) · med conf (~6 solds: Bonhams HK ~\$3,610 Aug-24 & \$4,939 Dec-25, Hargesheimer \$3,751 Dec-25, Christie’s HK Mar-24) · vintage Type 20 materially higher — the cheapest real chapter in the trio, and the owner’s \$4,250 offers sit dead mid-band

TIER

VALUE

THE SHARP PLAY (VERIFIED AUG 2026)

The reference to hunt is the **Aéronavale 3800 — no date** (1995): matt printed dial, typically serifed numerals (both serif variants exist across the run — not an authenticity tell), white-lacquer hands — the closest civilian echo of the 1950s military Type 20, which carried no date because the military didn’t order one. The date-at-6 examples are the **Transatlantique 3820** (1998): glossy dial, applied polished indexes, date inside the 6 o’clock counter — a dressier civilian cousin, acceptable only at a clear discount to a comparable 3800; for this chapter the no-date is the object. **Skip for this slot:** Type XXI 3810 (2004, 42 mm, central-minutes) and Type XXII 3880 (2010, 10 Hz).

INSPECTION

Working flyback (reset on the fly while running), bezel intact and clicking, unpolished case edges, and ask when the cal. 582 (Lemania-based) was last serviced — budget ~\$1k if never. Box/papers are nice-not-necessary at these prices. Honest dial, working flyback, no polish craters; the neo-vintage run is the affordable door into a lineage whose vintage examples have already been discovered.

STATUS — OFFERS OUT (2026-08-14)

Non-binding offers at \$4,250 submitted across a dozen-plus Chrono24 listings — fishing for the motivated seller who knows the December solds (\$3,751–4,939). Before accepting any bite: confirm the exact ref (some cheap listings are date-at-6 Transatlantique 3820s, not 3800s) and tritium vs luminova dial; total landed cost in writing; flyback reset-while-running on video; service history.

OWNER-OBSERVED MARKET (CHRONO24, 2026-08-13)

~20 listings under \$5,500, sharpest example \$4,500 (no box/papers) — a far lower ask floor than this draft’s first guess, and with supply that deep, clearing prices likely sit lower still. One honest caveat on the “75% off retail” framing: the ~\$27,200 new watch is the 2023-generation Type 20/XX — 42 mm, in-house flyback, a different watch — so the 3800 isn’t that watch discounted; it’s the 39 mm Lemania-based ancestor the market hasn’t bothered to love yet. Deep-supply-and-cheap also means weak demand: for a story-driven buyer who isn’t purchasing an exit, that is precisely the good kind of unloved.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 04 · 1907

TARGET

Historiques Chronomètre Royal 1907

The chronometry covenant, renewed

Ref 86122/000R-9362 · cal. 2460 SCC · 39 mm · released 2007



Photo: Vacheron Constantin press image (via Watchonista)

WHAT IT TEACHES

Ninety-two years after Breguet signed the covenant for the French navy, Vacheron signed it for the public: “Chronomètre Royal,” 1907, observatory-grade precision as a trademark promise. The 2007 centenary piece carries it in plain confident rose gold. In the trio’s structure this is the covenant’s second signing — Ch. 3 (1815) came before it, Ch. 15 (2015) answers it. *(The Aug 2026 review cut this as “a nameplate”; the reframe reversed that — the nameplate is the point.)*

CALIBRE 2460 SCC · automatic

SIZE 39 mm

RELEASED 2007 — centenary piece

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$15,500–19,000 · med conf · RG full set, dealer channel

TIER

CORE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Rose gold 86122, full set, recent service — the one verified sale was service-due, so price the service in.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE · CH. 05 · 1931

TARGET

Reverso Tribute Monoface Small Seconds

The shaped case

Steel · ref Q713842J (silver) or Q397843J (green) — verified Aug 2026



Photo: Jaeger-LeCoultre (manufacturer product pages)

WHAT IT TEACHES

The greatest single case idea of the twentieth century — born 1931 from polo officers’ broken crystals, executed as wearable Art Deco architecture. The plain small-seconds Tribute is the 1931 argument, current-production and Grande-Maison finished. (v1.0 taught the sonnet using only a parody — a complicated GMT; the plain case is the poem.)

REFERENCES Q713842J silver · Q397843J green sunray

METAL Steel, small seconds · current production

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$7,800–10,500 · low conf (0 solds priced — validate before buying) · steel, full set, dealer channel

TIER

CORE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Steel, small seconds; silver is the purest 1931 statement, the green sunray photographs unreasonably well (burgundy exists only in pink gold — a different budget conversation). Lightly-used full set; current-line depreciation works for you.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 06 · 1940s

TARGET

Triple Calendar 4240

The calendar in wartime Geneva

Ref 4240 (4241 sibling) · cal. 455/V495 family — verify per example · ~35 mm · 1940s



Photo: Sotheby's (Important Watches, Hong Kong 2019, lot 2116)

WHAT IT TEACHES

While Europe burned, Geneva's answer was defiant refinement — complete calendars in yellow gold, teardrop lugs, two-tone dials. The 4240 is the source material behind every modern Historiques calendar; own it beside Ch. 16 and you hold the same idea 75 years apart.

CALIBRE	455 / V495 family — verify per example
SIZE	~35 mm
PERIOD	1940s

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$12,000–18,000 · med conf · YG, sound original dial, auction incl. premium; PG/moonphase +25–30%

TIER

CORE, PATIENT

FACT-CHECK NOTE

Moonphase triples are the V485-family 4240L; the clean 4240 is non-moon, and Phillips catalogues a 1942 example with cal. 455 — verify calibre per example.

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Honest yellow-gold 4240, untouched two-tone dial. Hardest condition hunt in the guide — refinished calendar dials are epidemic; commission an Extract from the Archives as a condition of sale.

JAEGGER-LECOULTRE · CH. 07 · 1951

TARGET

Futurematic E501

The automatic, argued differently

Cal. 497 · ~37 mm · 1951–1957



Photo: Analog:Shift

WHAT IT TEACHES

When the industry agreed the automatic should simply add a rotor and keep the crown, JLC disagreed in public: crown deleted, set from a caseback disc, power-reserve indicator standing guard. The boldest production statement of the automatic decade — not “we can too” but “you’re all doing it wrong.” Your 2026 Master Control (F4) quotes its twin-register dial deliberately: this watch is why that watch looks the way it does.

CALIBRE	497 · automatic, back-set
SIZE	~37 mm
PERIOD	1951–1957

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$4,000–6,500 · low conf · steel, honest dial, working back-set · Buy first

TIER

VALUE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Steel, silver/beige dial, and the back-set must work — parts are unobtainium; a broken setting disc is a paperweight with provenance. Originality outranks cosmetic perfection. Best story-per-dollar in the collection.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE · CH. 08 · 1956–1960s

TARGET

Memovox Automatic Calendar E855

The watch that speaks

Cal. 825 (bumper) · 37 mm · 1960–c.1974



Photo: Bulang & Sons

WHAT IT TEACHES

The alarm is JLC’s signature voice — literally. The 1956 Memovox was the world’s first automatic alarm wristwatch; the E855 adds the date and keeps the period charm that the “automatic” is a bumper you can feel thump. Set it at dinner, hand it to a friend, watch their face when it rings.

CALIBRE	825 · bumper automatic alarm
SIZE	37 mm
PERIOD	1960–c.1974

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE	TIER
\$3,000–4,250 · med conf · steel, serviced, dealer channel · Buy second	VALUE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Steel, silver dial, applied markers; pay for a clean alarm disc and a strong case. Auction channel runs \$1,700–2,500 for trade-money lots — the discount is real and so is the reason.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 09 · 1955

STRETCH

Les Historiques Ultra-Fine 1955

The first crossing

Ref 33155/000R-9588 · cal. 1003 · 36 mm × 4.13 mm · released 2010



Photo: reference image — TO BE REPLACED at print; card ref is rose gold 33155/000R-9588 (source: The 1916 Company)

WHAT IT TEACHES

The thesis stops being a story and becomes an object. Calibre 1003 (1955) is 1.64 mm of movement — **JLC’s calibre 803, delivered from Le Sentier and finished by Vacheron to Geneva Seal standard.** One movement, two names, both houses at their best in 4.13 mm of watch. Hold it sideways and you hold the ébauche-and-finisher relationship this collection exists to explain.

CALIBRE	1003 (1955) — 1.64 mm; JLC’s cal. 803, Geneva-Seal finished by VC
SIZE	36 mm × 4.13 mm
RELEASED	2010

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE	TIER
\$11,000–15,000 · low conf (one realized sale) · RG, box and papers, global dealer	SPLURGE #1

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Rose gold canonical; buy on movement condition and case sharpness — ultra-thins forgive nothing. SPLURGE candidate #1 — the thesis made physical.

VC × JLC — THE CROSSING · CH. 10 · 1967–1977 TARGET

The calibre 920 / 1120 story

The engine JLC never signed

Told by the VC 222 (Canon) and its buyable descendant, the gen-1 Overseas (line from 1996; target ref 42042)



Photo: Phillips (The Hong Kong Watch Auction: X, lot 940) — 222 ref 44018

WHAT IT TEACHES

JLC’s 1967 calibre 920 — full-rotor, 2.45 mm — was so good that AP, Patek and Vacheron all adopted it, and JLC never once used it under its own name. As VC’s 1120 it powered the 1977 222, Jörg Hysek’s integrated-bracelet answer to the Royal Oak and Nautilus — which both ALSO ran on the 920. Every icon your friends are waitlisted for shares one engine; the engine came from the valley. This is the chapter you teach from.

THE HONEST OBJECT

222 (steel 44018) — Canon money since the 2022 reissue, standing order rules apply; band TBV

THE BUYABLE DESCENDANT

gen-1 Overseas — 1996 debut ref 42040 on cal. 1310; slightly later 42042 runs the upgraded cal. 1311

FACT-CHECKED AUG 2026

Both Girard-Perregaux-based, so either carries the lineage, not the calibre. A fairly-priced 1120-powered VC outranks both for this chapter (candidate refs TBV)

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

TIER

Band (42042): \$6,500–12,500 · med conf (4 solds ~12mo) · steel, dealer/auction · 222: Canon, standing order, band TBV

CORE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM (42042)

Steel, bracelet sharp and unstretched — the bracelet is the design. Full set strongly preferred.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 11 · 1972 TARGET

“1972” asymmetric

Geneva breaks symmetry

Original 1970s ref 35202-family, or the 1997 re-edition ref 37010 (cal. 1055) told honestly as an echo



Photo: Bulang & Sons — 1970s original, yellow gold (ref unstated: “35202-family”)

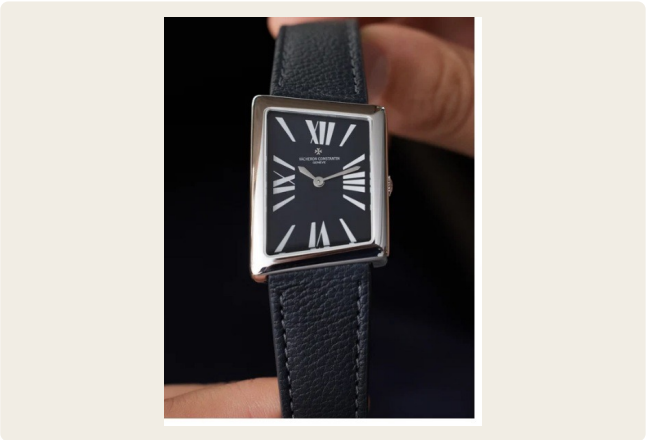


Photo: A Collected Man — 1997 re-edition 37010, white gold

WHAT IT TEACHES

In the year of the Royal Oak, when the industry bet everything on sporty steel, Vacheron accepted the Prestige de la France award and answered with a trapezoid — design courage of a kind that no longer exists. Fact-check correction carried forward: v1.0 unknowingly priced the 1997 re-edition (37010, ~26 × 36.5 mm) while describing the 1970s original (35202-family, 21 × 46 mm) — genuinely different objects.

THE CURATORIAL CHOICE (YOURS)

Hunt the true 1970s original (rarer, stranger, price TBV per example) or take the 37010 echo at a validated band. Both are defensible; only conflating them is not.

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

TIER

Band (37010 echo): \$8,500–12,000 · med conf · sharp unpolished case, auction/dealer · Original 35202-family: band TBV

CORE, PATIENT

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Condition-first shaped-case hunt either way — sharp edges are the design, most survivors are polished soft.

BREGUET · CH. 12 · 1970–1987

STRETCH

Chaumet-era Breguet — a Daniel Roth-hand revival piece

The quartz winter: keepers of the flame

Candidate refs pinned Aug 2026 (Phillips/Tahoma sources): moonphase + power reserve 3130 (solid back) / 3137 (display back), 36 mm coin-edge gold, pre-A-series from ~1987; perpetuals 3050 (1976) → 3057 → 3310 (1986, +PR); chronographs 3230/3237 on Lemania 2310. Roth's tenure: 1975–88, working in the Vallée de Joux from 1976. Band TBV.



Photo: The 1916 Company — ref 3137BA/11/986, yellow gold

WHAT IT TEACHES

The timeline's missing chapter — v1.1 jumped from 1977 to 1994 as if nothing happened. What happened was the quartz crisis, and while the industry drowned, a young **Daniel Roth** at Chaumet-era Breguet sat down and re-learned A.-L. Breguet's own language by hand: rose-engine guilloché, coined cases, secret signatures — the revival that taught the whole industry how to revive. Every "Historiques" and "Tribute" in this collection walks through the door Roth reopened. A Roth-era Breguet is the quartz winter's most beautiful act of defiance, and collectors have only begun to notice.

MOVEMENT BASES Ultra-thin cal. 502 · Lemania 2310 for the chronographs
ERA SIGNATURE 36 mm coin-edge (fluted) cases in yellow/white/pink gold

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

Evidence pass 2026-08-14:
\$14,000–22,000 auction/dealer-buy ·
LOW confidence — only two public
realized prices exist (2006, 2011);
dealer asks run \$20–31k; fresh comps
are MANDATORY before any purchase

TIER

CORE-to-SPLURGE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Hand-guilloché dial in honest condition is the entire object — no redials, no polished-out coin edges. **Fact-check nuance (Aug 2026): for a true Roth-tenure piece hunt the solid-back 3130 with a pre-A-series serial — the display-back 3137 arrived c.2001, post-Roth production of the same design** (still lovely, but a different chapter claim; price accordingly). Market TBV; this is the chapter where the evidence pass matters most, because the market is thin and moving. Possibly the trio's sleeping appreciation play.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 13 · c.2003

IN NEGOTIATION

Malte Dual Time Regulator

Geneva's eccentric interlude

Ref 42005/000G-8900 · cal. 1206 RDT (F. Piguet 1150 base, 65h) · 39 mm white gold



Photo: European Watch Company

WHAT IT TEACHES

Between revival and experiment, VC let itself be strange: regulator layout, minutes alone at center, hours exiled to a subdial, plus a second zone and calendar — an instrument made by a cathedral. Pairs with the owned Quai de l'Île (F2) as the "Vacheron dares" thread.

CALIBRE 1206 RDT — F. Piguet 1150 base, 65h
SIZE 39 mm white gold

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$11,000–14,000 · med conf · WG full
set, dealer channel

TIER

OPPORTUNISTIC

STATUS — IN NEGOTIATION (AUG 2026)

Verified record says nothing in WG has cleared above ~\$14.6k; supply 8-deep; trend ~-7%/yr (snippet-grade). Open \$10,500 · settle \$11,200–11,500 · \$12,000 only for full set + recent service + unpolished 39 mm case · walk at \$12,500. Take it if it lands right, lose no sleep otherwise.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE · CH. 14 · 2007

STRETCH

Duomètre à Chronographe

The complication laboratory

Ref Q6012420 · cal. 380 · 42 mm rose gold · 2007–2010s



Photo: Sotheby's

WHAT IT TEACHES

The purest modern expression of JLC-as-laboratory: two barrels, two independent gear trains — one for time, one for the chronograph — meeting only at the regulator. Start the chrono and the timekeeping loses nothing: the complication is quarantined from the truth-telling. A thesis about precision wearing a foudroyante hand.

CALIBRE	380 · manual, dual-wing
SIZE	42 mm rose gold
PERIOD	2007–2010s
ALTERNATE	Master Grand Réveil (Q163842A, steel PC+alarm, \$10,500–13,500 via Asian channel with service risk priced in) — architecture or maximal content; the chapter needs only one

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE	TIER
\$17,000–21,500 · med conf · RG full set, auction/dealer incl. premium	SPLURGE #2

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Early rose-gold Q6012420, full set; the market is drifting toward you — the old \$18k floor is now the center. SPLURGE candidate #2 — the modern engine argument.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE · CH. 15 · 2015

TARGET

Geophysic True Second

The covenant, renewed as wit

Ref Q8018420 · cal. 770 · 39.6 mm · 2015–c.2019



Photo: European Watch Company

WHAT IT TEACHES

A mechanical watch that ticks once per second on purpose — the observatory's dead-beat seconds reborn in a modern automatic named for JLC's 1958 Geophysic chronometers. The covenant's third signing: Breguet swore it to the navy (1815), VC to the public (1907), JLC to anyone paying attention (2015). Guests will say your watch is broken because it ticks like quartz; that conversation is the point.

CALIBRE	770 · automatic, true dead-beat seconds
SIZE	39.6 mm
PERIOD	2015–c.2019

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE	TIER
\$5,500–7,000 · med conf · steel/silver, full set, global channel · Buy third	VALUE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Steel, silver dial, full set — condition is easy, so pay for perfect and not a franc more. Global channel: the US shelf runs \$8–9k for what the world sells at \$5.9–6.7k.

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · CH. 16 · 2017

TARGET

Historiques Triple Calendrier 1942

The revival perfected

Ref 3110V steel · cal. 4400 QC · 40 mm · 2017–c.2022



Photo: Monochrome Watches (review, Oct 2017)

WHAT IT TEACHES

The Historiques program at full power — Ch. 6’s wartime calendar revived in steel with a hand-wound Geneva Seal movement. Beside the 4240 it teaches how a great house quotes itself without embalming itself — and it stands on the review’s best evidence: three sales inside 12 months within 1% of the band midpoint, trending up, lowest risk on the list.

CALIBRE	4400 QC · hand-wound, Geneva Seal
SIZE	40 mm steel
ALTERNATE	Historiques Toledo 1952 (47300 RG, \$13,500–16,500) — same chapter, shaped instead of steel. One or the other; both is collecting dials

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

\$16,500–19,000 · med conf · steel full set, online-auction/US dealer · the safest serious purchase in the guide

TIER

CORE

VARIANT & BUYING WISDOM

Slight preference blue accents; buy the cleaner full set at the sharper price.

SUFFIX WARNING

Sources conflict on whether blue is B425 or B426 — choose the dial with your eyes and verify the suffix on the seller’s spec sheet; don’t buy a reference string.

The curatorial calls still open

This half-card is intentional. Three decisions in this edition belong to the owner, not to the guide, and two references still need work before money moves.

CH. 1 — WHICH CLASSIQUE

The 7147 in silvered guilloché (band ASK-DERIVED, low confidence, zero public solds) or the ultra-thin 5157 (band validated on three solds, all older than 18 months). One slot; the 5157 is the value path.

CH. 11 — ORIGINAL OR ECHO

The true 1970s 35202-family original (rarer, stranger, price TBV per example) or the 1997 ref 37010 re-edition at a validated band. Both are defensible; only conflating them is not.

CH. 10 — THE UPGRADE PATH

A fairly-priced 1120-powered Vacheron outranks the gen-1 Overseas for this chapter. Candidate references remain to be identified and validated.

CH. 16 — THE SUFFIX

Resolve the 3110V B425 / B426 suffix-to-colour mapping before purchase. Choose the dial with your eyes; verify the suffix on the seller’s spec sheet.

CH. 12 — BEFORE ANY MONEY MOVES

The Roth-era band rests on two public solds (2006, 2011). Fresh comps are mandatory; the Roth-era perpetuals 3050 / 3057 / 3310 have n=0 and no band is offered at all.

JAEGER-LECOULTRE · F1 · 2012

OWNED / FOUNDATION

Master Ultra Thin Réserve de Marche

The quiet baseline

Q1378420 · cal. 938/1 · 39 mm · owned, \$5,350 — fairly bought (market \$4,800–7,000)



Photo: owner-supplied photograph of the owned watch

WHAT IT TEACHES

The classical JLC sentence-case; the calm against which the eccentrics read as eccentric. Its power-reserve thread now runs Futuromatic → here → Master Control.

CALIBRE	938/1
SIZE	39 mm

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

OWNED · \$5,350 paid — fairly bought (market \$4,800–7,000)

TIER

OWNED

VACHERON CONSTANTIN · F2 · 2016

OWNED / FOUNDATION

Quai de l'Île Self-Winding

The experiment

4500S/000A-B195 · cal. 5100/1 · 41 mm · owned, \$9,150 — well bought (market \$10,000–12,500, trending up)



Photo: owner-supplied reference image — confirm credit line at print

WHAT IT TEACHES

Vacheron at its least conventional; pairs with Ch. 13 as the “Geneva dares” thread. Bought below every ask the review observed.

CALIBRE	5100/1
SIZE	41 mm

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

OWNED · \$9,150 paid — well bought (market \$10,000–12,500, trending up)

TIER

OWNED

JAEGE-LECOULTRE · F3 · 2024

OWNED / FOUNDATION

Polaris Geographic

The present tense

Q9078640 · cal. 939 · 42 mm · owned/incoming, \$19,100



Photo: owner-supplied reference image — confirm credit line at print

WHAT IT TEACHES

Modern JLC travel engineering. The “overpaid” verdict rests on two listings and a wholesale buyback figure; wear it and let the data mature.

CALIBRE 939
SIZE 42 mm

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

OWNED · \$19,100 paid · provisional market
\$12,000–15,000 — evidence thin, see review \$9

TIER
OWNED

JAEGE-LECOULTRE · F4 · 2026

OWNED / FOUNDATION

Master Control Chronometre Date Power Reserve

The echo that closes the circle

Q4168120 · cal. 738 · 39 mm · pre-ordered, \$17,000, delivery Dec 2026 / Jan 2027



Photo: owner-supplied reference image — confirm credit line at print

WHAT IT TEACHES

The 2026 chronometer whose twin-register dial quotes the 1951 Futurematic. When it arrives and Ch. 7 sits beside it, the collection’s opening Idea (1796, on your wrist) and closing Echo (1951 ↔ 2026) will bracket two full centuries of the argument.

CALIBRE 738
SIZE 39 mm

MARKET BAND · CHANNEL · CONFIDENCE

PRE-ORDERED · \$17,000 · delivery Dec 2026 / Jan 2027

TIER
OWNED

Acknowledged, unranked, no capital assigned. **Promotion rule:** a papered example inside its band surfaces → it enters the plan and bumps its chapter's placeholder. The **VC 222 (steel 44018)** — the true object of Ch. 10, moved to Canon money by the 2022 reissue, band TBV — is carried on its own chapter card rather than repeated here.



Photo: A Collected Man (3357, white gold, 2016)

Breguet Classique Tourbillon

Roth-era 3350 (1988, the revival's first) → 3357

The 1801 patent itself; the invention every maison now sells back to us. Canon money in any honest form; the chapter is told in prose until a papered example inside a sane band surfaces. **Band validated 2026-08-14: \$28,000–42,000, med conf — 7 solds, freshest 19mo.**

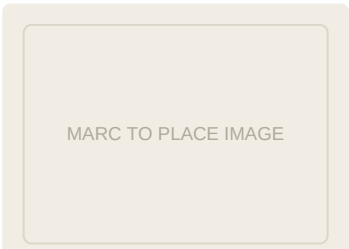


Photo: Montres Breguet / Swatch Group press

Breguet Souscription 2025

Ref 2025BH/28/9W6

The 250th-anniversary single-hand souscription reborn; noted for the record as the Idea's newest echo, and as new-retail money it stays Canon.



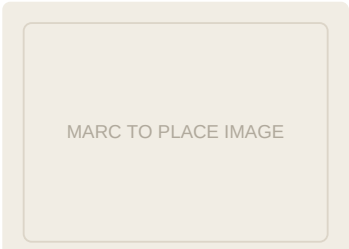
Marc to place image — primary source: Loupe This (3000px+, Old World map confirmed)

VC Mercator 43050

1990s revival · yellow gold, Old World map

The 1990s revival's most eccentric jewel (\$40,000–52,000, worst liquidity in the review). The timeline works without it and sings with it.

A chapter may legitimately be told by more than one watch. These are the sanctioned second tellers — one or the other, never both.

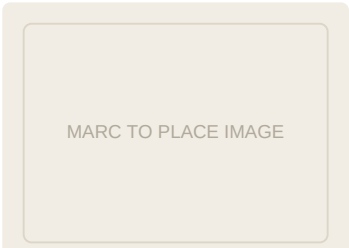


Marc to place image — primary source: European Watch Company (3400BB/12/996 · 5517TI/G2/5ZU)

Breguet Marine — neo-vintage 3400-family or current 5517

Alternate teller for Ch. 3

Tells the 1815 half without the aviation romance — one slot, your choice of century.



Marc to place image — primary source: European Watch Company

JLC Master Grand Réveil

Q163842A · steel · alternate for Ch. 14

Perpetual calendar + alarm in steel: \$10,500–13,500 via Asian channel with service risk priced in. Architecture or maximal content — the chapter needs only one.



Photo: Shreve, Crump & Low (47300/000R-9219); Sotheby's alternate

VC Historiques Toledo 1952

47300 RG · alternate for Ch. 16

Same chapter, shaped instead of steel, \$13,500–16,500. One or the other; both is collecting dials.

A collection is defined as much by what it refuses. These were considered and cut for reasons of story, not cost.

JLC ATMOS — SKIPPED BY OWNER DECISION, AUG 2026

A clock, however thesis-pure, redefines a wristwatch collection, and the service economics undercut its bargain band. The review’s evidence — high confidence, \$400–2,000 — stays on file if the itch ever returns.

MALTE PR/DATE 83060

No chapter — the power-reserve story is owned three times over.

AMVOX2

A second logo with an unassignable reference. Caseback edition test 750 = Chronograph / 999 = DBS if one ever tempts.

ARONDE 1954

Its scarcity story was false.

GRANDE REVERSO GMT

Demoted — the Reverso chapter is the 1931 case, not the complications later stuffed into it.

TOLEDO / GRAND RÉVEIL

Not cut: alive as alternates inside Chs. 16 and 14.

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

HISTORICAL BASIS

The trio is treated as three roles in one conversation: Breguet as the Idea (Paris, from 1775), Jaeger-LeCoultre as the Engine (the Vallée de Joux, from 1833) and Vacheron Constantin as the Cathedral (Geneva, from 1755). Milestones, references and calibres are drawn from manufacturer material, auction catalogues and specialist archives, and were put through a 31-claim fact-check completed 2026-08-14: 27 of 31 CONFIRMED, with corrections applied to this edition.

MARKET METHODOLOGY — BANDS, CHANNEL, CONDITION, AS-OF

Every band in the plan is validated against sold and completed transactions, JLC/VC bands sold-weighted as of **2026-08-13** and the Breguet evidence pass folded in **2026-08-14**. Each card states its band with the channel it applies to (auction incl. premium, dealer, global vs US shelf), the condition assumed (metal, full set, unpolished case, service history) and its confidence grade. Dealer askings were never treated as market. Bands are working acquisition ranges for the described variant, not appraisals.

THE TWO FLAGGED EXCEPTIONS — STATED PLAINLY

1. Breguet Classique 7147: the \$13,000–18,000 figure is **ASK-DERIVED, low confidence** — zero public solds were found. Negotiate hard against it, or take the ultra-thin 5157 path, whose \$8,000–13,000 band rests on three solds (all older than 18 months). **2. Chaumet-era / Daniel Roth Breguet:** the \$14,000–22,000 band is **LOW confidence** — only two public realized prices exist (2006 and 2011) while dealer asks run \$20–31k. **Fresh comps are mandatory before any purchase.** The Roth-era perpetuals (3050 / 3057 / 3310) have n=0 and no band is offered.

OTHER LIVE UNCERTAINTIES CARRIED INTO PRINT

VC 222 (steel 44018) band TBV · the 1970s “1972” 35202-family original has no band, only the 1997 37010 echo does · 1120-powered VC references for Ch. 10 remain to be identified and validated · the 3110V B425/B426 suffix-to-colour mapping is unresolved and must be verified on the seller’s spec sheet · F3 Polaris Geographic market is provisional on thin evidence.

CORRECTIONS APPLIED IN THIS EDITION

Cal. 505SR is Tradition-family / souscription architecture, NOT 502 / F. Piguet — the “shared Vallée DNA” bridge was cut · gen-1 Overseas = 42040 / cal 1310 at debut, 42042 / cal 1311 later · 3800 serifed numerals are “typical”, not universal, and not an authenticity tell · Aéronavale deliveries from 1960, Air Force 1955–59 · the display-back 3137 is c.2001, post-Roth: the Roth-tenure piece is the solid-back 3130 · the review’s \$6.2 Toledo hypothesis was refuted — cal. 1125 is JLC 891-based, not 889.

OWNED AND IN-PROGRESS PIECES

Five pieces are owned or on order: the Tradition 7097 cornerstone (Ch. 2), Master Ultra Thin Réserve de Marche (\$5,350, fairly bought), Quai de l’île (\$9,150, well bought, below every observed ask), Polaris Geographic (\$19,100 against a provisional \$12,000–15,000 — evidence thin) and the pre-ordered 2026 Master Control (\$17,000, delivery Dec 2026 / Jan 2027). Purchases are logged honestly, above band as well as below.

PHOTOGRAPHY POLICY

Reference photography is credited on-card and in the index. Manufacturer, auction-house and specialist-dealer images are identified by source; where no image has yet been supplied, the card carries a labelled placeholder rather than a substitute watch. Marc-supplied photography continues for owned pieces — the 7097 takes the best Marc original in the document. One card carries an interim frame flagged for replacement: **Ch. 9**, where the supplied photograph should be swapped for a rose-gold 33155/000R-9588 image before print.

COLLECTION RULE

A watch earns a chapter only if it is a documented crossing between the houses, or the definitive statement of a virtue one house owns outright. Promotion rule: a papered Canon example inside its band surfaces → it enters the plan and bumps its chapter’s placeholder.

Image credits for this edition, per the companion source files *Swiss Artisans v2.0 image sources (Breguet)* and *(JLC-VC)*. Cards awaiting a photograph carry a labelled placeholder. Marc-supplied photography continues for owned pieces — the 7097 deserves the best Marc original in the whole document; it is the frontispiece now.

BREGUET CHAPTERS

Ch. 1	Classique 7147 / 5157	breguet.com product pages	Refs verified (guilloché /12/, enamel /29/); packshots on-page (site blocks extraction)
Ch. 2	Tradition 7097	breguet.com; Naked Watchmaker macros	WG 7097BB & RG 7097BR pages; movement macros from Naked Watchmaker — but a Marc original leads
Ch. 3	Type XX 3800ST/92/9W6	European Watch Company	Steel/black, direct image. Supplied frame is the bracelet variant 3800ST/92/SW9 — same dealer, label accordingly
Ch. 3	Vintage Type 20	Phillips (1967 tropical, WINNING ICONS lot 5; 1965 Geneva SEVEN lot 121)	Archive-provenance civilian pieces w/ direct images; true Marine Nationale example only off-list (Amsterdam Vintage Watches)
Ch. 3 alt	Marine 3400BB & 5517TI	European Watch Company	Neo-vintage WG and current titanium, both direct images — image to place
Ch. 12	Roth-era 3137BA/11/986	The 1916 Company	Moonphase + PR, display back, direct images
Canon	Tourbillon 3357	A Collected Man (WG, 2016)	Sotheby's Jun 2026 YG lot as alternate
Canon	Souscription 2025BH/28/9W6	Breguet / Swatch Group press	Monochrome launch photos as backup

JAEGER-LECOULTRE × VACHERON CONSTANTIN CHAPTERS

Ch. 4	CR 1907 86122/000R	VC press (via Watchonista)	Modest resolution; best available — flagged
Ch. 5	Reverso Tribute SS	Jaeger-LeCoultre product pages	Q713842J silver · Q397843J green; pull packshot from page
Ch. 6	VC 4240	Sotheby's HK 2019, lot 2116	YG two-tone, teardrop lugs, confirmed NO moonphase
Ch. 7	Futurematic E501	Analog:Shift	Steel, silver, JLC-branded European-market example
Ch. 8	Memovox E855	Bulang & Sons	Steel, silver, date, JLC bracelet; Wind Vintage backup
Ch. 9	Ultra-Fine 1955	The 1916 Company	Exact ref, studio macros; no 4.13 mm profile shot yet. IMAGE TO BE UPDATED — the frame in this edition reads warm gold; replace with a rose-gold 33155/000R-9588 photograph
Ch. 10	VC 222 44018	Phillips HK Auction X, lot 940	The integrated-bracelet hero shot
Ch. 10	Overseas 42042	Loupe This	Exact ref, blue Arabic, 2400px; early-2000s example — image to place
Ch. 11	“1972” original	Bulang & Sons	YG asymmetric; ref unstated — keep “35202-family”
Ch. 11	37010 re-edition	A Collected Man	White gold (original above is yellow — label both)
Ch. 13	Malte DTR 42005/000G	European Watch Company	Exact ref, WG silver, 9-shot gallery
Ch. 14	Duomètre Q6012420	Sotheby's	RG 6-image gallery; cal 380 caseback frame unconfirmed
Ch. 14 alt	Grand Réveil Q163842A	European Watch Company	Exact ref, straight-on dial — image to place
Ch. 15	Geophysic Q8018420	European Watch Company	Exact ref, steel/silver
Ch. 16	3110V	Monochrome Watches review	Both accent variants shown; suffix conflict — see card
Ch. 16 alt	Toledo 47300	Shreve, Crump & Low; Sotheby's	RG 000R-9219
Canon	Mercator 43050	Loupe This	YG Old-World map confirmed, 3000px+ — image to place
F1	MUT Réserve de Marche Q1378420	Owner-supplied photograph	The owned watch, on the wrist — placed
F2	Quai de l'île 4500S/000A-B195	Owner-supplied reference image	Placed — confirm the credit line at print if the frame is a dealer or manufacturer image
F3	Polaris Geographic Q9078640	Owner-supplied reference image	Placed — confirm the credit line at print if the frame is a dealer or manufacturer image
F4	Master Control Q4168120	Owner-supplied reference image	Placed — confirm the credit line at print if the frame is a dealer or manufacturer image

Recurring caveat from the sourcing run: breguet.com, jaeger-lecoultre.com and swatchgroup.com time out under automated fetch — every manufacturer packshot must be pulled from the product page in a browser. Phillips, European Watch Company, A Collected Man and The 1916 Company all expose direct, hotlinkable image URLs, recorded in the companion files.